

Magistrates

Are appointed by God.

Romans 13:1 Let every soul be subject unto the higher powers. For there is no power but of God: the powers that be are ordained of God.

Are ministers of God.

Romans 13:4 For he is the minister of God to thee for good. But if thou do that which is evil, be afraid; for he beareth not the sword in vain: for he is the minister of God, a revenger to execute wrath upon him that doeth evil.

Romans 13:6 For for this cause pay ye tribute also: for they are God's ministers, attending continually upon this very thing.

Purpose of their appointment.

Romans 13:4 For he is the minister of God to thee for good. But if thou do that which is evil, be afraid; for he beareth not the sword in vain: for he is the minister of God, a revenger to execute wrath upon him that doeth evil.

1 Peter 2:14 Or unto Governors, as unto them that are sent by him for the punishment of evildoers, and for the praise of them that do well.

Their office to be respected.

Acts 23:5 Then said Paul, I wist not, Brethren, that he was the High Priest: for it is written, Thou shalt not speak evil of the ruler of thy people.

Are not a terror to the good, but to the evil.

Romans 13:3 For rulers are not a terror to good works, but to the evil. Wilt thou then not be afraid of the power? do that which is good, and thou shalt have praise of the same:

To be wisely selected and appointed.

Exodus 18:21 Moreover thou shalt provide out of all the people able men, such as fear God, men of truth, hating covetousness; and place such over them, to be rulers of thousands, and rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens:

Ezra 7:25 And thou, Ezra, after the wisdom of thy God, that is in thine hand, set magistrates and Judges, which may Judge all the people that are beyond the river, all such as know the laws of thy God; and Teach ye them that know them not.

To be prayed for.

1 Timothy 2:1-2 I exhort therefore, that, first of all, supplications, prayers, intercessions, and giving of thanks, be made for all men; 2 For kings, and for all that are in Authority; that we may lead a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness and honesty.

SHOULD

Seek wisdom from God.

1 Kings 3:9 Give therefore thy Servant an understanding heart to Judge thy people, that I may discern between good and bad: for who is able to Judge this thy so great a people?

Rule in the fear of God.

2 Samuel 23:3 The God of Israel said, the Rock of Israel spake to me, He that ruleth over men must be just, ruling in the fear of God.

2 Chronicles 19:7 Wherefore now let the fear of the LORD be upon you; take heed and do it: for there is no iniquity with the LORD our God, nor respect of persons, nor taking of gifts.

Know The Law of God.

Ezra 7:25 And thou, Ezra, after the wisdom of thy God, that is in thine hand, set magistrates and Judges, which may Judge all the people that are beyond the river, all such as know the laws of thy God; and Teach ye them that know them not.

Be Faithful to the Sovereign.

Daniel 6:4 Then the presidents and Princes sought to find occasion against Daniel concerning the kingdom; but they could find none occasion nor fault; forasmuch as he was Faithful, neither was there any error or fault found in him.

Enforce the laws.

Ezra 7:26 And whosoever will not do The Law of thy God, and The Law of the king, let Judgment be executed speedily upon him, whether it be unto Death, or to banishment, or to confiscation of goods, or to imprisonment.

Judge wisely.

1 Kings 3:16-28 Then came there two women, that were harlots, unto the king, and stood before him. 17 And the one woman said, O my lord, I and this woman dwell in one house; and I was delivered of a child with her in the house. 18 And it came to pass the third day after that I was delivered, that this woman was delivered also: and we were together; there was no stranger with

us in the house, save we two in the house. 19 And this woman's child died in the night; because she overlaid it. ...

Hate covetousness.

Exodus 18:21 Moreover thou shalt provide out of all the people able men, such as fear God, men of truth, hating covetousness; and place such over them, to be rulers of thousands, and rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens:

Not take bribes.

Exodus 23:8 And thou shalt take no gift: for the gift blindeth the wise, and perverteth the words of the Righteous.

Deuteronomy 16:19 Thou shalt not wrest Judgment; thou shalt not respect persons, neither take a gift: for a gift doth blind the eyes of the wise, and pervert the words of the Righteous.

Defend the poor, ect.

Job 29:12 Because I delivered the poor that cried, and the Fatherless, and him that had none to help him.

Job 29:16 I was a Father to the poor: and the cause which I knew not I searched out.

Judge for God, not for man.

2 Chronicles 19:6 And said to the Judges, Take heed what ye do: for ye Judge not for man, but for the LORD, who is with you in the Judgment.

Judge righteously.

Deuteronomy 1:16 And I charged your Judges at that time, saying, Hear the causes between your Brethren, and Judge righteously between every man and his brother, and the stranger that is with him.

Deuteronomy 16:18 Judges and officers shalt thou make thee in all thy gates, which the LORD thy God giveth thee, throughout thy tribes: and they shall Judge the people with just Judgment.

Deuteronomy 25:1 If there be a controversy between men, and they come unto Judgment, that the Judges may Judge them; then they shall justify the Righteous, and condemn the wicked.

Be impartial.

Exodus 23:6 Thou shalt not wrest the Judgment of thy poor in his cause.

Deuteronomy 1:17 Ye shall not respect persons in Judgment; but ye shall hear the small as well as the great; ye shall not be afraid of the face of man; for the Judgment is God's: and the cause that is too hard for you, bring it unto me, and I will hear it.

Be diligent in ruling.

Romans 12:8 Or he that exhorteth, on exhortation: he that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence; he that sheweth mercy, with cheerfulness.

Subjection to their Authority enjoined.

Matthew 23:2-3 Saying, The scribes and the Pharisees sit in Moses' seat: 3 All therefore whatsoever they bid you observe, that observe and do; but do not ye after their works: for they say, and do not.

Wicked Illustrated.

Proverbs 28:15 As a roaring lion, and a ranging bear; so is a wicked ruler over the poor people.

Good Exemplified.

Joseph,

Genesis 41:46 And Joseph was thirty years old when he stood before Pharaoh king of Egypt. And Joseph went out from the presence of Pharaoh, and went throughout all the land of Egypt.

Gideon,

Judges 8:35 Neither shewed they kindness to the house of Jerubbaal, namely, Gideon, according to all the goodness which he had shewed unto Israel.

Samuel,

1 Samuel 12:3-4 Behold, here I am: Witness against me before the LORD, and before his anointed: whose ox have I taken? or whose Ass have I taken? or whom have I defrauded? whom have I oppressed? or of whose hand have I received any bribe to blind mine eyes therewith? and I will restore it you. 4 And they said, Thou hast not defrauded us, nor oppressed us, neither hast thou taken ought of any man's hand.

Nehemiah,

Nehemiah 3:15 But the gate of the fountain repaired Shallun the son of Colhozeh, the ruler of part of Mizpah; he built it, and covered it, and set up the doors thereof, the locks thereof, and the bars thereof, and the wall of the pool of Siloah by the king's garden, and unto the stairs that go down from the city of David.

Job,

Job 29:16 I was a Father to the poor: and the cause which I knew not I searched out.

Daniel,

Daniel 6:3 Then this Daniel was preferred above the presidents and Princes, because an excellent spirit was in him; and the king thought to set him over the whole realm.

Wicked Exemplified.

Sons of Samuel,

1 Samuel 8:3 And his sons walked not in his ways, but turned aside after lucre, and took bribes, and perverted Judgment.

Pilate,

Matthew 27:24 When Pilate saw that he could prevail nothing, but that rather a tumult was made, he took water, and washed his hands before the multitude, saying, I am innocent of the blood of this just person: see ye to it.

Matthew 27:26 Then released he Barabbas unto them: and when he had scourged Jesus, he delivered him to be crucified.

Magistrates in Philippi,

Acts 16:22-23 And the multitude rose up together against them: and the magistrates rent off their clothes, and commanded to beat them. 23 And when they had laid many stripes upon them, they cast them into prison, charging the jailor to keep them safely:

Gallio,

Acts 18:16-17 And he drave them from the Judgment seat. 17 Then all the Greeks took Sosthenes, the chief ruler of the synagogue, and beat him before the Judgment seat.

And Gallio cared for none of those things.

Felix,

Acts 24:26 He hoped also that money should have been given him of Paul, that he might loose him: wherefore he sent for him the oftener, and communed with him.